

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankkar Aiyar

Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta,
Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta,
HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon

Photo Editor: Bandep Singh

Art Editor: Sapnaa Kapoor

Associate Editors: Bhavna Vij-Aurora, S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal,
Sandeep Unnithan, AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar,
CHANDIGARH: Ramesh Vinayak, LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra

Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee,

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen

Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar,

BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran

Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish;

BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra,
MUMBAI: Jhilimil Motihar, Aditi Pai; PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava

Copy Desk: Nardeep Singh Dahiya (Senior Editor), Kaushik Deka,

Rahul Kumar, Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shilpi, Priyanka Sood, Shveta

Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbant Negi,
Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh,

AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar,

MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul,

Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,

Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors),

Rasmi Ajmani Girdhar, Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),

Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Manager: Upendra Wellingkar (West and South)

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram

(Chennai), Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)

Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha,

Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director

D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager

Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)

Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager, Sales (West)

M. Krishna Kiran, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)

S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIV Number 3; For the week
Jan 13-19, 2009; released on Jan 12

● Principal Office: 110001, Connaught Place New Delhi
110001, Phone: 23412801-4, Fax: 23411159, Cable: Indmedia, New Delhi
● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61,
Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301; Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from
BISL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900
from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080;
e-mail: wecare@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444233-6; Fax: 24444358 ● Sales:

Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited,

101, Competent House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi ● Regd.

Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 ● Mailed Offices: Trade Centre,

2nd Floor, Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Ground, Mumbai 400013;

Phone: 23493355; Fax: 23492266 ● Chennai Office: 1-A, Connaught Place, New

Delhi 110001; Phone: 23422133; Fax: 23327159 ● 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Sala,

2nd Floor, Madhavaram, Chennai-600 061; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177

Into In; Fax: 28472118; Cable: Livmedia Chennai ● 201-204 Richmond

Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448,

22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore ● 52,

Jawaharal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398;

Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata ● 63-66677777, Rajajiguda,

Hyderabad-500006; Phone: 23401657, 23400900; Fax: 2340104, 23402481,

13410992, 23411195; Cable: 23401657 ● 89/90, Sarabhatt Road, Kochi 682016;

Phones: 23412088, 23412088; Fax: 2377029 ● 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor,

Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006;

Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 ● Copyright Living Media India Ltd.

All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is

prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media

India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura

Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana) ● 9/10, Maraimalai complex, Maraimalai

Nagar, Kanchi, Kanchipuram-605020, Tamil Nadu ● 10/10, Plot No. 5-5A,

T.K. Industries, 1st Floor, Belpur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708,

(Maharashtra) ● Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.

● INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited

publication material.

From the editor-in-chief

Terror has changed the world. 9/11, 12/13, 3/11, 7/7 and now 26/11. These are no longer just numbers or dates but have become turning points for countries who have suffered bloody and ghastly terror attacks. And so it was with us on the 26/11 attacks in Mumbai which triggered a national crisis and public outcry of unprecedented scale. The response needs to be equally unprecedented from those responsible for protecting India's security, sovereignty and its citizens. There has been a flurry of activity: increased security, changes in anti-terror laws, coastal surveillance and new agencies for better coordination of intelligence. That is all for the good. But there is a worrying question mark over India's ability to bring about radical and durable change in what is referred to as "the system". Are these measures enough? Will they work? These need to be discussed and critically examined in the public domain.

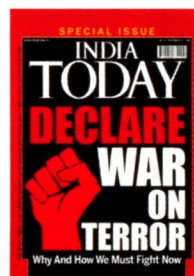
We at the India Today Group were also motivated into action by the Mumbai events. We believed that the anger shown by the general citizenry against our shameful failures must be channelised into a constructive framework which can prepare us better for the future. Public opinion is the greatest force for change in a democracy. With that in mind, we launched a movement called 'Declare War on Terror' which invited the public to send their suggestions on tackling the crisis to a panel of experts. The campaign stretched across all our media outlets and elicited tremendous response where 94,759 (and still counting) pledged to be part of the movement. As a culmination of this movement, the Group's editors decided to produce an agenda which looks critically and in exhaustive detail at the key areas which need major change and reform.

We identified 12 such areas of concern, from agencies responsible for co-ordinated action against terror, how the intelligence apparatus needs to respond, the need to strengthen existing laws and how to secure our coastlines and other new areas of vulnerability. Two other vital issues are how we tackle Pakistan and also ensure the armed forces are geared to tackle the new security threats. Finally, there is a citizen's charter, measures and precautions that all of us need to embrace to make our cities more secure.

In each of the areas, journalists with the requisite background consulted a panel of experts in that particular field to put together an action plan which lists immediate, medium and long-term goals and requirements. This agenda, which we believe is the most comprehensive and radical to emerge post 26/11, will be presented to the prime minister with the fervent hope that the Government will take note of the suggestions to make India more secure. In this issue, we present the salient features of our agenda. The entire text will be on our website from January 12.

For too long, we have been seen as a soft state by those who would like to undermine our democracy and our future as a global power. It is time to transform our strategies, our institutions and our mindset to meet the new challenges and threats. Failure to do so will be the greatest and most unforgivable betrayal of the Indian public. And it would mean that the Mumbai tragedy amounted to naught.

(Aroon Purie)



OUR DECEMBER
15, 2008 COVER